

Linkerd adds native support for the Model Context Protocol

Buoyant, the creator of Linkerd, the open source service mesh for cloud-native and Kubernetes environments, has announced upcoming support for the Model Context Protocol (MCP). This move positions Linkerd as the first open source service mesh to natively support MCP, offering a unified and secure foundation for both traditional microservices traffic and agentic AI-driven communication.

By adding MCP support, Linkerd will extend its lightweight security, observability and traffic management capabilities to agentic AI workflows. This includes metrics on resource and tool usage, latency and failure rates, along with fine-grained, identity-based access controls built on Linkerd's existing zero-trust framework. The aim is to provide a single mesh layer that maintains consistent policy enforcement across all workloads.

"Enterprises are eager to innovate with AI, but they cannot do so at the expense of their security posture and application reliability," said William Morgan, CEO of Buoyant. "Linkerd solves this problem by extending its proven capabilities to MCP traffic. We are giving organisations the tools to accelerate their usage with confidence."

Full MCP support will be available in 2026 across both the open source Linkerd distribution and Buoyant's enterprise offering.



The move will make the company's service ecosystem publicly accessible to local garages, fleet operators, and independent mechanics, allowing them to repair and maintain Ola's electric two-wheelers without relying solely on its in-house network.



Under Phase 1, Ola Electric will sell genuine spare parts directly through its app and website. In Phase 2, the company plans to launch online diagnostic tools and technician certification programmes, empowering third-party repairers to service Ola vehicles independently.

"We have built our service ecosystem from first principles, using technology to make it fast, transparent, and efficient. With Hyperservice scale-up, we are opening up this capability to everyone," said Bhavish Aggarwal, chairman and managing director at Ola Electric.

"Every garage, fleet and customer can now access the same high-quality tools and systems that power Ola's own network. Genuine parts, full transparency, and no middlemen. This is true service freedom, only possible in a D2C model," he added.

Microsoft open sources Azure MCP Server v1.0

Microsoft has released the stable version 1.0.0 of Azure MCP Server, implementing the Model Context Protocol (MCP) to serve as an interface between AI agents and



Azure services. The move enables developers to query, manage, and automate Azure cloud resources using natural language or code. Significantly, Microsoft has open sourced the entire project, making both documentation and source code available on GitHub.

The launch underscores Microsoft's growing commitment to open source collaboration. The Azure MCP Server allows developers to customise, extend, and integrate MCP not only with Azure-based AI frameworks but also with third-party systems. The underlying Model Context Protocol, an open standard, unifies communication between large language models (LLMs) and backend systems, regardless of the agent frameworks used. This open source release invites the wider AI and DevOps community to build, test, and contribute integrations across multiple cloud ecosystems.

The server currently supports over 47 Azure services, including Azure AI Foundry, AI Search, Event Hubs, Service Bus, PostgreSQL, Kusto, Function Apps,